

SURREY SCOUT

OCTOBER, 1979

No. 388

Leader Training

Elsewhere in this issue, tributes have been paid to Eric Walden, but it is particularly appropriate to record here the very great contribution which he made to Leader Training and Bentley Copse. Whilst it is the responsibility of a County Commissioner to ensure that adequate facilities exist for the training of adult Leaders there are few who are so dedicated as to take the specialist training needed to qualify as a

Leader Trainer and take a prominent role in courses of all types. Countless numbers of Leaders from all sections of the Movement in Surrey and in G.L.S.W. will recall his contribution to the courses they attended. His fellow members of the County Training Team will remember him with affection and thanks for the support which he gave whenever there was a need.

DAVID BARRELL

Courses

Pack Holiday Course

Bentley Copse 10th/11th November

General Information Courses

Woking 7th October
Surbiton 7th October
Wallington 14th October
Wimbledon 18th & 25th October

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

Mrs. D. Martin, 103 Lovelace Drive, Pyrford.
D. Whiteman, 17 May Close, Chessington.
Mrs. E. Morgan, 27 Barrow Avenue, Wallington.
M. Orbell, 28 Acacia Drive, Sutton.

Basic Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Surbiton 13th/14th October
Leatherhead 1st/2nd December
Guildford 22nd/23rd March 1980
Croydon 23rd/24th February 1980

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.
R. Penfold, 49 Wolverton Gdns., Horley.
D. Brown, 21 Langsmead, Blindley Heath, Lingfield.
D. Brown, 21 Langsmead, Blindley Heath, Lingfield.

SCOUT LEADERS

Woking 27th/28th October
Croydon 24th/25th November

D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.
H. Smith, 266 Whitehorse Lane, S.E.25.

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 22nd/23rd March 1980

B. Wood, 36 Sole Farm Road, Gt. Bookham.

GROUP SCOUT LEADER

Croydon February/March 1980

D.R. Barrell, 1 Beech Road, Reigate.

Advanced Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Morden 21st October &
(non-residential) 4th, 18th, 25th November

E.W. Daniel, Flat 7, Barfield Court, Ladbroke Road, Redhill.

County Commissioner

"Let diaries be brought into use" wrote Sir Francis Bacon in an essay on travel. Coming across this odd and seemingly unhelpful snippet in the "Oxford Dictionary of Quotations", while inevitably looking for something else, made me pause for thought. How many of us have witnessed that all too familiar scene at the end of a meeting when attempts are made to fix the date of the next one? Out come the diaries and with them everyone's reasons why the meeting cannot be fixed for this day or that day until weeks after the ideal time. Programmes start slipping and planning and preparation go by the board. Something starts to suffer and if it is Scouting then we have done less than our best.

We all get ourselves into this fix from time to time but in so many cases it could have been avoided. Anyone who has anything to do with Scouting inevitably has a lot of commitments. Whether these are Group, District, County or National events and meetings, all are candidates for the diary. Furthermore, some of the meetings will be held at regular

intervals throughout the year. There is no excuse for not fixing these up a full year ahead.

Every committee secretary can play an important part here and make a useful contribution to improving the standard of efficiency in Scouting administration. Getting the meetings fixed a year at a time really does take a lot of "hassle" out of the job and makes everybody's life easier. The last item on the agendas for any meetings for the next month or two should therefore be - "Meeting dates for 1980".

The 1980 diaries are appearing in the shops now, including "Scouting" diaries which of course are also available in Scout Shops. Get one quickly and fill those Scouting engagements for 1980. No less important, fill in the family engagements at the same time! Folk who carelessly fix Scouting engagements on their wedding anniversaries or on that special person's birthday, thoroughly deserve their "come uppance".

Let diaries be brought into use. Make a date now.

GORDON BATES

County Chaplain

There was once a smuggler in the Far East, very well known, who used to wander over the international borders with donkeys which had panniers on their backs. He did this year after year. He became richer and richer. Every time the custom officers stopped him they took the straw out of the panniers and found absolutely nothing. As time went on, the searches became more thorough. Even the donkeys' ears were searched and checks were made for drugs. Still they could not find anything. Still the smuggler grew richer and richer. Eventually he retired and went to live in another country. One day a retired customs officer met him and asked, "What on earth were you smuggling for all those years?" The smuggler smiled and said, "Donkeys!"

Isn't that the art which lies in the whole approach of the Scout Movement to its teaching of standards of behaviour and patterns of belief? No boy joins because of a desire to be good, or to believe. But if we Scouters do our job then we will smuggle in much of what is in the Law and Promise while the boys are doing something else. A lot of it will be done quite unconsciously, by our unprepared actions and words as much as by any carefully put together act of worship. Indeed there are times when WE do not know we are smuggling donkeys in either.

For example, there was one harrowing occasion a few years ago when I was involved with a council estate family whose young daughter drank some weed killer being kept in a lemonade bottle. The hospital fought for the girl's life, but she died. For the parents came a terrible mixture of grief and guilt. I visited, often just sitting in helpless silence with the family. I prayed with them, in words which seemed trite. They listened in a slightly uncomfortable silence and murmured an Amen. I went off feeling a total failure.

A week or two later, one of my colleagues met the father in a local pub. They talked. Suddenly the father said, "It was only when the vicar prayed that I got some idea that there was a God, and that he did care for us." So God had smuggled the donkey of his love into a human disaster . . . and none of us had known he was doing it.

Perhaps we sometimes worry too much, carry too big a feeling of guilt about how we do - or do not - transmit something of the Law and Promise to boys. We need to remind ourselves that the Bible has something to say about the way in which God often uses what seem to be weak people, weak things to reveal his glory . . . and that includes us. With his help, I reckon more of us are successful donkey smugglers than we know!

KEITH HUXLEY

Water Activities

County Regatta

We had a truly fine day for the Regatta on Sunday May 13th and there were plenty of entries for a full day's activity. Owing to the long Winter and the difficulty of getting on to the water until quite late into the Spring this year, there was less time than usual for practice. As a result, perhaps it might be said that the general level of training exhibited during the regatta was not as high as usual. Nevertheless, there was plenty of keen racing and enthusiasm. I am particularly pleased to say the turn out and smartness was the best I have seen at a County regatta for several years. That isn't to say that it cannot be further improved and I look forward to next year being absolutely tip top.

This year's overall top marks were won by 1st Cuddington (Warspite) with 24 points. 1st Molesey and Ajax each had 19 points.

The canoeing trophy and the sculling trophy both went to 1st Molesey, while the pulling trophy went to 1st Thames Ditton (Ajax). Top overall marks for the Venture Scouts section went to 3rd Staines. Hearty

congratulations to Warspite and also to 1st Molesey who have done so well this year. Also thanks to Paul Norman of 1st Molesey and numerous members of 1st Walton-on-Thames (Viking) who made the regatta run smoothly.

The Cock of the River trophy which will be determined by the results of the Sailing Regatta could really go to any one of three groups, since the points are very close together. On the subject of closeness of points, I would take the liberty of mentioning that I would be happier if in future regattas there were fewer protests. One would like to see a regatta perfectly run with perfect rules which are perfectly adhered to. However, the difficulties of doing this with anything but perfectly rehearsed and trained Scouts is impossible. Much more important perhaps, is to allow a wide selection of boys to race and to pit themselves against others. As long as no unduly unfair advantage accrues to one crew against a competitor, I feel it would be more in the Scouting spirit to let the best man win without splitting too many hairs.

JOHN FORBAT

County Directory

East Surrey

A.D.C. (Scouts). Delete J.M. Grossmith.

Insert C.E. Stewart, 17 Dormans Close, Dormansland, Lingfield. Tel. 832095.

Tatsfield. Delete R.F. Dredge

Insert B.A. Geliot, Pine View, Ricketts Hill Road, Tatsfield, Near Westerham, Kent. Tel. Tatsfield 744.

1st Hedgecourt. Delete R.J. Argyle.

Insert M. Miller, Mandalay, Hophurst Hill, Crawley Down, West Sussex. Tel. East Grinstead 714181

Haslemere

A.D.C. (S.F.) D. Luck. Tel. now Wormley 3852

Staines

A.D.C. (L.T.) Delete P.S. Hill.

Insert c/o D.C.

A.D.C. (V.S.) Delete B.C. Lake

Insert c/o D.C.

County Diary

October

1	Scout Sub-Committee	Leatherhead
2	Cub Scout Sub-Committee	Leatherhead
8	County Programme & Training Sub-Committee	Bookham
13	Chief Scout's Award Presentation	Farnham
14	Rifle Club Annual Shoot	Bisley
17	County Executive Committee	B.-P. House
28	County Service	Guildford Cathedral

November

10	County Swimming Gala	Guildford
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December

4	Water Activities Sub-Committee	Cuddington
6	Venture Scout Sub-Committee	Dorking
11	County Finance Sub-Committee	

November "Surrey Scout"

Copy Date	12th October
Distribution	28th October

Cub Scouts

By now I am sure you are all aware that there will be an activity day for all Cub Scouts within the County during the weekend 5th/6th July 1980 at five different sites.

The name for the event is to be "Cub Meet 80" and your Pack will be able to attend one of the sites which have been located on a regional basis to reduce both the travelling time and cost.

The regional sites and the districts attending are as follows :

Walton Firs

Staines
Runnymede
Surrey Heath
Sunbury & Shepperton

Blacklands

East Surrey
Caterham
Horley
Reigate
Dorking

Hook Road Arena

Ewell
Walton & Weybridge
Leatherhead
Banstead

Polyapes

Epsom
Esher
Woking

Farnham Pack

Farnham
Haslemere
Godalming
Guildford

Until each regional committee has met, we will not know the exact date for your Pack or the precise format for your site, so please book the whole weekend now and we will give more information of the dates earlier in January.

Cub Country

The total received by Headquarters for the Cub Country project as at 11th September was approximately £39,000.

STEVE HALL

Venture Scouts

First Aid Competition 1979

This year's competition took place on Sunday, 8th July, 1979, at Bentley Copse training area. Once again only seven teams took part, but I believe that those participating enjoyed the event, and learned a lot more First Aid.

My thanks go to Woking District Scout Fellowship who helped organise and run the event.

The competition results are as follows :-

1st	1st Merrow V.S.U. - Guildford	221½
2nd	1st Woking V.S.U. - Woking	195
3rd	Royal Grammar School - Guildford	194
4th	8th Woking (Juno) V.S.U. - Woking	156
5th	17th St. Joseph's V.S.U. - Reigate	138½
6th	Ashley Joint Unit '1' - Epsom	137½
7th	Ashley Joint Unit '2' - Epsom	133

Best Individual Test 1 +3: Paul Hayler - 1st Woking V.S.U. 41

Best Individual Test 2 + 4: Tie
(Giles Chamberlin - 1st Merrow V.S.U. 47
(Judith Fisher - 1st Merrow V.S.U. 47

TIM BENSON

(Competition Organiser)

Mountaineering

Introduction to Mountaineering Course

A course for Scouters, Instructors and Venture Scouts over 18 will be run in North Wales over the weekend 23rd/25th November 1979 with a preliminary instructional meeting (probably in Banstead) on 18th November 1979. The aim of the course will be to give a basic introduction to hill-walking and its value as a Scouting activity. The anticipated cost is £15 which will include all food, transport and accommodation in the G.L.S.W. Activity Base at Bethesda. Full details from Joe Waters, 4 Hurst Road, Horley, Surrey. Tel: Horley 74792.

JOHN MUSTON

ERIC J. WALDEN

Scouting suffered a very great loss in the sudden death on the 18th August, 1979, of Eric J. Walden, County Commissioner for Greater London South West.

Eric was not in the Movement as a boy but joined as a lay member in 1954 when he was elected to the Executive Committee of the South Croydon and Waddon Division of Croydon. A year later he became Chairman of the Division but only remained in that office for a year as he soon realised that work with the boys themselves really attracted him and he became Assistant District Commissioner in 1956, later being appointed District Commissioner, a position he held from 1960 to 1963.

Work with the older boys and young men had a special appeal for him and he became Assistant County Commissioner for Rover Scouts for Surrey in January 1963, holding that appointment until March 1965. After a short spell away from England he returned to find Scouting re-organised into its present form with a large part of urban Surrey and a part of Middlesex forming the new County of Greater London - South West. He was immediately re-appointed his old rank as Assistant County Commissioner and one year later he succeeded John Beresford as County Commissioner.

Training at all levels was a matter of great impor-

tance to him and he, himself, obtained his Wood Badge within the year of getting into uniform. He began assisting with Courses in 1962 and in 1975, following attendance at a National Leaders Training Course, became a Leader Trainer for Surrey and G.L.S.W. He was skilful with tools and would often be seen at Cub Scout Leaders' Courses run by his wife, Mary, teaching the uses of a saw, hammer, etc.

An able and articulate speaker, a keen judge of people, he was universally liked. To quote from a tribute by the Guide County Commissioner for Greater London West: 'He was certainly one to lead by example, always extremely smart both in and out of uniform'... We are the richer for knowing him'.

At National level he was a member of the Awards Board.

For his outstanding services to Scouting, the Chief Scout awarded him the Silver Acorn in 1968 and the Silver Wolf in 1976.

Eric was a fine example of a true SCOUT and there are a considerable number of people in Scouting and in other organisations who have lost a very great friend.

Our deepest sympathy goes to his widow, Mary, (of the Records Office at Lancing) and to his sons, Alan (who works at Baden-Powell House) and Peter.
D.G.C.

ERIC WALDEN MEMORIAL FUND

'To enable his many friends, colleagues, and all who enjoyed his leadership, to render a lasting expression of their regards, a fund has been set up. For many this will be an opportunity to register their affection and gratitude for the inspiration he gave to G.L.S.W. as an emerging Scout County. Already contributions in lieu of flowers have come from various sources.

His interest and participation, with Mary, in the County Training team makes her request that thought be given to the refurbishing of the kitchen at Bentley Copse a fitting aim. The kitchen itself is to be renewed.

In part this is a result of Eric's concern that, for the good of the young we serve, all our Leaders should be highly trained. And, in giving their time to this end, deserve the best of support facilities.

Please send all contributions (cheques payable to G.L.S.W.) to the County Treasurer, Mr. A.C. Allan, 2, Meopham Green, Kent. DA13 0AY.

The above appears in the G.L.S.W. news and is reprinted here for those Readers of the "Surrey Scout" who would like to be associated with this memorial.

Pieces and Bits

Over to You

OVER TO YOUTH, a new BBC radio series is aimed at anyone working with young people, especially those who work with them in their leisure time.

The series focuses on what young people have to say about issues which matter to them and then the interviewers will talk to youth workers and look at ways in which they can work more effectively with young people.

Each of the eight half-hour programmes will look at a particular topic: Home, School, Sex, Abortion and Contraception, Money, Drink and Drugs, Work and Marriage.

The transmission details are:

Sundays, Study on 4, Radio 4 VHF (92.95), 30th September to 18th November 3.30 - 4.00.

A set of programme notes will be available from the BBC, Continuing Education (Radio) Broadcasting House, London W1A 1AA. Further information is also available from the Relationships Secretary at Headquarters.

Smith's Charity

This Charity makes small sums of money available for Capital projects such as new buildings, extensions, renovations and improvements. Any Group or District wishing to be considered for financial assistance must make application on the appropriate (available from D.C.) to P.F. Lankester, Ryedale, Cross in Hand Road, Heathfield, East Sussex, TN21 0UR, to reach him before 1st November.

Congratulations

SILVER CROSS

David Daniels 1st Hurst Green

CHIEF SCOUT'S COMMENDATION FOR MERITORIOUS CONDUCT

R. Leonard 4th Camberley

MEDAL OF MERIT

R. Bligh G.S.L., 16th Reigate
D.H. Faulkner G.S.L., 3rd Epsom,
D.S.L., Epsom

T.R. Maggs A.V.S.L., Ashley, Epsom
V.S.U., A.D.C. (V.S.) Epsom

R.J. Pope Member District Executive
East Surrey

N.D. Newland G.S.L., 5th Guildford
R. Watson A.S.L., 1st Cuddington

R.J. Wraith Group Treasurer,
Holy Trinity (Guildford)

CHIEF SCOUT'S COMMENDATION FOR GOOD SERVICES

W.B. Clinton Group Treasurer 4th Woking
W. McVitty Group Treasurer 1st Lagham

H. Richardson Group Treasurer 1st Godstone
District Appointments Secretary East Surrey

H.W. West Group Lay Member 1st Fetcham

QUEEN'S SCOUT AWARD

Graham Beck 9th Walton-on-Thames
Roger Dolan 9th Walton-on-Thames

CHIEF SCOUT'S AWARD

Neil Atkin Otlands

David Baker 1st Lagham

Blair Crawford 3rd Staines

David Crooke 3rd Staines

Andrew Duncan 7th Epsom

Aldo Errico 1st Ruxley

Nicholas Greenwood 1st Tadworth

Lewis Hampson Royal Grammar School, Guildford

Paul Jansen 3rd Epsom

Ian Joyes Otlands

Nick Keal 1st Cuddington

Anthony Lallem 3rd Epsom

David Martel Royal Grammar School, Guildford

Rory Matier 1st St. Johns

Robert Millar Royal Grammar School, Guildford

Paul Mitchell 1st Hersham

Kevin Moore 3rd Staines

Paul Ollington 1st Egham Hythe

David Page 1st West Byfleet

Adrian Peckham Royal Grammar School, Guildford

David Rodway Royal Grammar School, Guildford

Adrian Skilbeck Royal Grammar School, Guildford

Andrew Tappin 1st Normandy

Piers Taylor Otlands

Simon Thorley Royal Grammar School, Guildford

Guy Upward 1st St. Johns

David Walter 1st Lagham

Mark Walter 1st Lagham

Ian Whitehead 3rd Epsom